

Post-incident review PIR-2025-055

Search Service: elevated error rates

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 10 June 2025, Search Service experienced elevated error rates in production (AU East) for about 18 minutes. A developer in another team noticed their integration tests failing against the service. Investigation found that one tenant's bulk import consumed most of the shared queue throughput.

Impact

Users of Search Service saw elevated error rates for about 18 minutes. The service owner, Digital Channels, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:10 First signal received.
- 09:34 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:50 Likely cause identified.
- 10:29 Mitigation applied.
- 10:31 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that one tenant's bulk import consumed most of the shared queue throughput.

No dependency outages were reported by upstream providers during the window.

There was no documented procedure for this failure mode, so responders worked it out live.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

The relevant alert had fired repeatedly the previous week and had been muted by the on-call engineer.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Add a pre-deployment check that validates the setting against the production baseline.
- Write and rehearse a runbook for this failure mode.
- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.